

Lab: Perform Cybersecurity Skills' Readiness Check

Estimated time needed: 15 minutes

If you're aiming for a cybersecurity career, figuring out where you stand in terms of skills is crucial for landing the right role. In this hands-on lab, you will take stock of your strengths and weaknesses in cybersecurity. This assessment will help you understand your competency levels to be an effective cybersecurity professional.

Objectives

In this lab, you will:

- Assess your cybersecurity skills
- Develop an improvement action plan to reach the expected skill levels

Prerequisites

- You have a Template/Answer spreadsheet for this lab in Microsoft Excel format. Ensure you have Excel installed on your computer or a Microsoft 365 online account. Alternatively, you can open Excel documents using other spreadsheet application software, like Google Sheets.
- Review the following:
 - Video: **The Role of the Cybersecurity Professional**
 - Reading: **Career Pathways: NICE Framework**

Exercise 1: Assess your current cybersecurity skills

In this exercise, you will assess your current skill levels in different skill categories.

1. Keeping the CTRL key pressed, click [here](#) to download the **Cybersecurity Skills Inventory** spreadsheet.
Note: Use the COMMAND key instead of CTRL on Mac systems.
2. Review the **Cybersecurity Skills Inventory** spreadsheet. It lists skills in the different skill categories and fields, including **Current Skill Level**, **Intended Skill Level**, and **Action Plan**.

Skill Category	Key Skill	Current Skill Level	Intended Skill Level	Action Plan
Securely Provision	Network Security			
Securely Provision	Security Architecture			
Securely Provision	Systems Engineering			
Operate and Manitain	Incident Response			
Operate and Manitain	Security Operations			
Operate and Manitain	Vulnerability Management			
Protect and Defend	Penetration Testing			
Protect and Defend	Security Awareness and Training			
Protect and Defend	Intrusion Detection Systems			
Investigate	Digital Forensics			
Investigate	Malware Analysis			
Investigate	Cyber Threat Intelligence			
Collect and Operate	Security Data Collection			
Collect and Operate	Cyber Threat Hunting			
Collect and Operate	Information Collection and Analysis			
Analyze	Security Data Analysis			
Analyze	Behavioral Analysis			
Analyze	Risk Analysis			
Support and Administration	Security Policy and Compliance			
Support and Administration	Security Administration			
Support and Administration	Security Training and Awareness			

3. Evaluate your skill level and select the most appropriate skill level from the menu in the **Current Skill Level** column.

	Current Skill Level	I
	High	
	Moderate to High	
	Moderate	
	Moderate to Low	
	Low	

Repeat this step for each skill.

4. Review your ratings.

Exercise 2: Develop an action plan to reach the intended skill levels

In this exercise, you will determine the intended skill levels and develop an action plan for a maximum of five skills to reach the goal.

1. Choose 3 to 5 skills you believe you need to improve.
2. Select the most appropriate intended skill level using the menu in the **Intended Skill Level** column.
3. Add an action plan for reaching the intended skill level for the selected skills. Include steps that will help you measure your progress and the time you plan to reach the intended skill level.
4. Save this file for future use.

Note: Your improvement planning should be continuous.

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